

### Luke 14:31-33

- <sup>31</sup> Or what king, going to make war against another king, sitteth not down first, and consulteth whether he be able with ten thousand to meet him that cometh against him with twenty thousand?
- <sup>32</sup> Or else, while the other is yet a great way off, he sendeth **an ambassador**<sup>G4242</sup>, and desireth conditions of peace.
- <sup>33</sup> So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple.

The English word “ambassage” appears once in the entire Bible and so, like the 4,001 other *hapax legomenon*, it could be challenging to obtain the Biblical definition of this word.

To compound the difficulty, this word does not appear in Noah Webster's 1828 dictionary. Note that it does appear in the Webster's 1913 dictionary where it equates “ambassage” to “embassage” which is not a word that appears in the Bible. Additionally, the sources for the definitions for “ambassage” in Webster's 1913 dictionary explicitly state that they come from non-Biblical sources.

The peg words (words that surround the word in question) do not exist anywhere else in scripture so confirming a parallel concept would likely not be wholly free from doubt.

We could *guess* the definition based on the context; however, guessing begets opinions and opinions beget confusion and God is not the author of confusion (1Cor 14:33). And thus it's always safe to assume that the Lord provided a way to definitively confirm His word definitions and they will never change (Mal 3:6a).

So, we don't have a Biblically-sourced dictionary definition, we have no peg words, no parallel verses, no parallel passages, and we dare not guess (Mat 23:3, Luk 12:47,48, Jam 3:1). How then can we confirm *with scripture* the definition of this word? In 1Cor 2:13d God's word gives us a clue: use God's word! English is not the first language God has used to preserve His word and it will also not be the last (John 1:45, Act 4:12, Rom 1:16, Rev 5:9, Rev 14:6,7).

The Strong's number for “ambassage”, which is G4242, appears elsewhere in scripture making the total count exactly two (Num 35:30, Mat 18:16).

### Luke 19:12-15

- <sup>12</sup> He said therefore, A certain nobleman went into a far country to receive for himself a kingdom, and to return.
- <sup>13</sup> And he called his ten servants, and delivered them ten pounds, and said unto them, Occupy till I come.
- <sup>14</sup> But his citizens hated him, and sent **a message**<sup>G4242</sup> after him, saying, We will not have this *man* to reign over us.
- <sup>15</sup> And it came to pass, that when he was returned, having received the kingdom, then he commanded these servants to be called unto him, to whom he had given the money, that he might know how much every man had gained by trading.

And so we learn *from scripture* that “an ambassage” is “a message” and “a message” is “an ambassage”.